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Education

Norwegian School of Economics (NHH) <i>PhD in Economics</i>	<i>2023 – Exp 2027</i>
University of Oxford <i>Visiting Student</i>	<i>2026 – 2027</i>
University College London (UCL) <i>MSc in Economics (Distinction)</i>	<i>2021 – 2022</i>
Maastricht University <i>BSc in Economics (Honours)</i>	<i>2018 – 2021</i>

Research Interests

Labor Economics, Applied Microeconomics,
Economics of Children and Families, Economics of Education

Work in Progress

The Intergenerational Costs of Family Migration

Families relocate for many reasons, and joint household moves raise household income sharply while setting the mother's career back and leaving the father's essentially untouched. This paper asks how such moves affect the children who move with them. Using Norwegian register data, I match 109,641 families who undertake a joint within-country move to their five nearest observationally identical non-mover families and trace children's adult outcomes as a function of the child's age at the time of the move. Moving lowers children's educational attainment and adult income, and the cost rises steeply with the age at which the child moves: children who move between ages 12 and 16 are 3.0 percentage points less likely to be in college at 24 and rank 2.3 percentiles lower in their birth cohort's income distribution at age 30, whereas children who move before school age show no detectable loss in college attendance and rank only 0.5 percentiles lower. Neither of two natural mechanisms accounts for the full cost: moves to worse neighborhoods and moves that set back the mother's career relative to the father's are more harmful, but sizeable losses remain even for moves to better places and for moves that leave the intra-household earnings gap unchanged. Much of the intergenerational cost of family migration thus appears to be a direct disruption cost borne by the child, a cost that standard household calculations of the returns to moving omit.

Spillover Effects of Public Childcare on Firms with Astrid Kunze

This study examines whether the expansion of publicly provided childcare affects firms' labour demand and performance. Using Norwegian register data, we follow public and private sector firms around the 2002 Childcare Act, which increased childcare coverage for 1–2-year-olds from 40 % in 2002 to universal coverage by 2008. We estimate intention-to-treat effects using a firm-level event-study difference-in-differences design that exploits the quasi-random rollout across all municipalities. The results indicate positive demand-side responses: firms increase hiring and experience higher employment growth following the expansion. Moreover, firms shift their workforce composition, hiring relatively younger and more highly educated workers. We

also find improvements in operational performance, suggesting that childcare expansion can affect firms not only through labour supply but also through productivity-related channels. The effects are more pronounced for the private sector.

Gender Composition in High-Stakes Exams and Educational Sorting with Catalina Franco and Marcela Gomez-Ruiz

Women now outperform men in many educational outcomes, yet remain underrepresented in selective tracks and high-return fields. This paper studies whether the gender composition of a high-stakes testing environment affects exam performance and educational choices. We use administrative data from 52,000 applicants to Colombia's top public university, where random assignment to exam rooms generates exogenous variation in the female share. A one-SD increase in the female share raises women's scores by 1.55 % of a SD, with no effect on men's overall performance. It also reduces applications to health majors for both women and men, and increases women's admissions, with gains concentrated in arts majors. Survey evidence shows no effect on stress, exam-related worries, or perceived exam difficulty. Instead, the pattern is consistent with applicants using the gender composition of the exam room to infer the competitive environment they face. These findings highlight that, even without peer interaction, temporary social cues in high-stakes settings can translate into consequential differences in performance, field sorting, and access to future opportunities.

Teaching Experience

2026: Econometrics (MSc level, NHH)

2024 – 2025: The Economics of Petroleum and the Energy Transition (MSc level, NHH);
Macroeconomics (MSc level, NHH)

Presentations at Workshops and Conferences

2026: 5th Gender and Economics Workshop (Luxembourg);
8th Annual Conference of the Baltic Economic Association (Riga, Latvia);
Royal Economic Society Annual Conference (Newcastle, UK);
10th International PhD Meeting in Economics (Thessaloniki, Greece);
Asian and Australasian Society of Labor Economics Conference (Beijing, China) *

2025: Family Policy, Careers and Workplace Technology Workshop (Oslo, Norway);
47th Meeting of the Norwegian Association of Economists (Bergen, Norway)

* Scheduled.

Grants and Awards

2026: Norges Bank's Fund for Economic Research;
Prof. Wilhelm Keilhaus Minnefond Research Stipend

Additional Training

2024: Demand and Supply in Labor Markets (Magne Mogstad, University of Oslo);
Micro-econometrics (Jeffrey Wooldridge, Barcelona School of Economics);
Labor Market Adjustment to Economic Shocks (Jan Stuhler, University of Bergen)

Skills

- **Software:** Stata (advanced), L^AT_EX (advanced), R (basic)
- **Languages:** Chinese (native), English (fluent), Norwegian (basic)

Last updated: September 2026